



JARED F. HELM

Cover Letter

jaredfhelm@gmail.com · 385-237-5056 · linkedin.com/in/jaredfhelm · github.com/jaredfhelm · sentrymandate.com

TARGET: Enterprise Customer Success · Technical Account Management · Technical Program Management

Dear Hiring Team,

I have built my career refusing to choose between the codebase and the customer. I operate entirely at the critical seam where deep technical development, business operations, and customer relationships meet. I bring “owner’s empathy” to every account — because I have personally carried the P&L, engineered the stack, and shipped the product.

My background is defined by this multi-disciplinary approach:

Operations & Scale: I spent a decade as General Manager of a high-volume auto auction, paying my way through my CSIS coursework. I ran live floor operations while quietly modernizing the software underneath them — and sales grew year-over-year for ten straight years. There, I learned that customer trust is not a pitch, but small deposits with the same people, week after week.

Delivery & Relationship Governance: At Black Box Code and SMPL Finance, I served as the bridge between technical architectures and enterprise clients. I specialized in protecting developers from scope churn while translating complex milestones into clear, high-level business reports for decision-makers. When I sit with a client’s project owners, I am not merely sympathizing; I have carried their deadlines.

AI & Automation Systems: Most recently at Sentry Mandate, I dove headfirst into the AI shift, building custom coding agents and proof-gated automation systems from the ground up.

What I want now is a permanent home: a team where this unique blend of building and relationship management goes into helping enterprise clients choose their future instead of reacting to it.

I would love to discuss how my diverse experience can bring immediate value to your team. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Jared F. Helm



Never let the person across the table be surprised.

EXPERIENCE

Founder / AI Operations Specialist

2023 - PRES

Sentry Mandate LLC & Independent Consulting

Left corporate delivery the year GPT arrived and founded Sentry Mandate at the front edge of the AI shift, combining a lifetime of operations and customer relations with the new machines. I build my own coding agents and the proof-gated systems that run them. SHIPPED: AIOS, tinygate, Daughters of Courage, The Cockpit, Microsoft Atlas, Piper, tbot, gritty, El Niño, Blue Dragon (page 4).

Senior Project Manager

2021 - 2023

SMPL Finance

Walked into a financial product moving faster than its process: scope shifting weekly, executives and engineering each holding their own version of the truth. Took over program governance — procurement and vendor coordination, resource management, risk and dependency tracking — and put both sides on one set of business and technical reports. Release, marketing, and compliance milestones stopped colliding.

Technical Project Manager

2018 - 2020

Black Box Code

Clients came to us when their own stack had become the enemy, and we rebuilt it from the inside out. I orchestrated client and internal engineering as one unit, tailored task-management systems and automations to each engagement, and jumped in front of the train so architects, developers, and designers never felt the scope churn. Engineers kept their focus, TDD took root, and delivery dates held.

General Manager & Lead Systems Engineer

2008 - 2018

Auto Auctions of America

Joined to pay for school (UVU CSIS); stayed a decade and rose to General Manager, hiring and leading the floor and office teams. Increased sales year over year for ten straight years — refactoring the aging Java-based auction software and website, running creative advertising, winning dealer and bank accounts, and selling on the floor myself. Hundreds of cars a week: customers for life, built on radical trust.

Early Experience

EARLY

Mrs. Fields Cookies (Corporate) · Sizzler

Corporate catalog sales and strategic account acquisition at Mrs. Fields HQ; Sizzler host/server at fifteen — working, selling, and serving ever since.

PROFILE

Lifelong technical builder, career spent customer-facing — from a decade on a live auction floor to enterprise software delivery. Writing code since 1999; selling and serving since fifteen.

Ownership is my empathy: I have carried payroll, runway, and launch dates, so I understand the account owner across the table — and I can read their stack as fluently as their P&L.

BEST-FIT ROLES

- Customer Success Account Manager
- Technical Account Manager
- Solutions Lead
- Technical Program Manager
- Senior PM

CORE STRENGTHS

- Relationship Building
- Stakeholder Alignment
- Escalation Shielding
- Executive Reporting
- Technical Deep Dives
- AI Automation

EDUCATION

Utah Valley University (UVU)

Computer Science & Information Systems (CSIS)
· Classical OOP coursework

Salt Lake Community College (SLCC)

Computer Science & Information Systems (CSIS)
· Coursework



THE SEAM I LIVE ON

Most careers pick a side: technical or customer-facing. Mine never did. Every chapter — auction floor, engineering shop, finance PMO, AI lab — has been both at once. That seam is where enterprise accounts are won and kept.

WHY CUSTOMERS TRUST ME WITH THEIR ACCOUNTS

Trust at a live auction is earned in public: same floor, same faces, week after week, with money on the line. Ten years of that builds a reflex — never let the person across the table be surprised. As the face of a company, I bring bad news early and with a plan, translate the roadmap into their outcomes, and stay accountable long after the signature.

- Face-of-the-company presence, earned on live auction floors
- Escalation shield: problems find me before they find the team
- PM instincts — deadlines exist because campaigns and budgets do
- Owner's empathy — I know what runway and payroll feel like
- Fluent in complex specs, architectures, and security postures
- Builder: I can prototype the fix, not just file the ticket

HOW I RUN AN ACCOUNT

Twenty years in IT and program management, and it was never the tooling that carried me: not the Gantt charts, not the kanban boards, not the sea of reports. What carried me was the customer. Their definition of success, seen from high enough that the whole picture fits in one frame — that is the work I love. I win when the customer does: their success made legible to both sides, their executives and our engineers, until delivery, renewal, and expansion stop being separate conversations. At SMPL Finance, that meant pulling both into one version of the truth — shared numbers, shared milestones — and the weekly collisions between release, marketing, and compliance stopped.

- LISTEN** **Learn what they are actually carrying.** Not the org-chart version — revenue targets, campaign dates, budget runway, and the people whose jobs depend on delivery.
- TRANSLATE** **Bridge the two languages.** Technical specs into business outcomes for their executives; business pressure into precise, respectful asks for our engineers.
- DELIVER** **Make trust compound.** Program reviews, delivery cadence, honest status, early escalation, and proof — so every renewal conversation starts from evidence, not persuasion.

OPERATING THESIS

The account everyone else calls difficult is usually the one nobody has listened to. The tangled stack, the shifting scope, the stakeholders who have stopped believing — I learn the business, earn a seat at the table, and the relationship outlasts the contract.



WHAT I BRING INTO THE ROOM

Customer & Account Leadership

Relationship Building · Strategic Account Acquisition

- Customer Success Planning · QBRs & Executive Business Reviews
- Renewals & Expansion · Onboarding & POCs
- Discovery & Demos · Escalation Management
- Security Questionnaires · Executive Briefings
- Voice of Customer · CRM & Pipeline Workflows

AI / Systems Automation

LLM Agents · Multi-Agent Systems · Custom Harness Building

- Task-Management Systems · Tool-Calling · RAG / Embeddings
- Model Routing · Context Engineering · Proof-Gated Automation
- Evaluation Flows · Approval Gates
- Dashboards / Internal Tools

RECENT HANDS-ON WORK

Designed, built, and shipped by me.

AIOS — my swing at what the operating system becomes next PLATFORM

What Windows and macOS look like after AI: agents doing real work under real accountability. 1,100+ skills, a typed capability graph, one rule — **work is finished when the test passes, not when the AI says so.**

Daughters of Courage AUTO-RESEARCH

Autonomous cancer-research system — 18 specialist AI “brains” write evidence-graded, PubMed-cited theses (367 canonized) and debate to consensus under an AI arbiter, giving patients calm, sourced answers.

tinygate MIT · OSS

One-file, zero-dependency proof gate for AI agents — “done” means a stored proof command exiting green. Cut tokens 32% at matched quality on a 100-task benchmark.

Microsoft Atlas GRAPH

Zero-dependency Node.js knowledge graph of Microsoft’s org — deterministic content-addressed ingestion, graph-native BM25 retrieval (no vectors), WebGL2 topology UI, read-only self-fact-checking assistant.

Blue Dragon Coins E-COMMERCE

E-commerce company I built end to end — a Rust live-commerce trust stack: SHA-256-locked pack manifests, append-only audit ledger, custody reconciliation across public site, buyer app, and admin.

Program & Delivery Leadership

Technical Program Management · Program Governance

- Cross-Functional Leadership · Stakeholder Alignment
- Roadmaps & Backlog Management
- Risk & Dependency Management · Budgeting & Procurement
- Vendor Management · Team Building · SDLC
- Agile / Scrum / Kanban · TDD Culture · Jira & Confluence
- ClickUp · Executive Reporting

Technical Fluency

AI-Assisted Development (Coding Agents) · Java · Rust · C++

- TypeScript · Python · SQL (PostgreSQL / SQLite)
- REST APIs & Webhooks · Git & GitHub Actions (CI/CD) · Docker
- Linux · AWS · Stripe / Billing Integrations

tbot TRADING

Pure-math Rust market maker for Polymarket crypto contracts — 20 crates pricing fair value in nanoseconds, no LLM. 67% win rate in months of simulation against live market data; held from real trading for compliance.

The Cockpit LEAD-GEN

Vehicle-lead operating system — de-dupes cross-posted listings into one canonical vehicle, then a deterministic state-machine outreach funnel. AES-256-GCM-vaulted PII, every reveal audited. In production.

Piper / tinypiper AGENT

Hybrid AI agent distilled to one ~130-line file — deterministic routing: no-LLM instant answers where possible, local models next, cloud only when needed. Sandboxed tools.

El Niño FORECASTING

Deterministic ENSO→commodity forecasting engine — every prediction sealed in a write-once ledger and graded against reality; a single as-of gate makes future-data leakage impossible.

gritty MIT · OSS RUST

Native Windows terminal multiplexer in Rust, rendered on CPU — no GPU, no Electron. Tabs, splits, session restore in a sub-800 KB binary.

AI operations, project leadership, and business execution are no longer separate lanes. The companies that win will be the ones that never forget the human on the other side of the table — and build the systems that support them.